

Trade a bad piece for an active one

Positional Judgment

THE IDEA

An exchange can improve your position by changing relative piece quality even when material stays equal. Compare what each piece currently does and what it could do after the trade. Labels such as 'good bishop' need concrete targets.

WORKED EXAMPLE

If your restricted bishop can exchange for the opponent's active knight, your remaining pieces may gain freedom. But if that bishop is the only defender of key dark squares around your king, the exchange can be dangerous.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What is the essential before-and-after comparison?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Identify which tasks disappear on each side and which weaknesses remain. The best trade removes an important enemy function without creating a more serious problem for you.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Exchange functions, not just equal point values.